

MOBILE HARDWARE: GPU

In the previous chapter we gave you a peek into the world of SoCs, and primarily its CPU component, here we look at the fabled GPU

Before the advent of huge touchscreen phones the CPU was the only thing handling all the processing that a mobile application needed. Simply because given the processing capabilities of the CPUs of that generation the visual elements present in most applications were quite simple. The idea of providing a similar experience on smartphones and tablets akin to that found on desktops and laptops led to the adoption of a distributed architecture like what's found on personal computers. So now, we have the SOC with a CPU and GPU on a single chip. Now, the entire graphical workload can be offloaded onto the GPU.

What is a GPU?

A Graphical Processing Unit, is that part of the SoC(System on Chip) that handles the image processing, 2D processing and also the 3D processing.